Precursor– A substance from which another is formed, especially by metabolic reaction.

Primer – A short oligonucleotide that hybridizes the template strand and gives a 3' – OH end for the initiation of nucleic acid synthesis.

Probe – The probe is a single stranded DNA molecule that is 'complementary' to the gene of interest in a sample under study.

Pseudopodia – Blunt temporary protoplasmic projections found in Amoeba or in some amoeba-like cells.

Psychoactive drug - A chemical substance that acts on brain and affects the mind and behaviour of user.

Puberty – Period of reproductive maturity.

Pyrolysis– Decomposition brought about by high temperatures.

Recombinant– A cell or organism whose genetic complement results from recombination.

Redia – Larva in the life cycle of most trematodes.

Rheoreceptors – They are receptors in fish and some amphibians that respond to water currents.

Saltation – Single step large mutation.

Satellite DNA – Short highly repeated eukaryotic DNA sequences, usually clustered in heterochromatin and generally not transcribed.

Saltatorial – Saltatorial is an animal adapted to leaping. They have large, muscular hindlimbs and sometimes, reduced forelimbs. A few example for jumpers in the animal kingdom include fleas, froghoppers, grasshoppers, and frogs.

Schizogony - The process of multiple fission, in which one organism divides to produce many daughter cells.

Schizont – The trophozoite of Plasmodium grows in size to form the schizont.

Selection – Choosing the better adapted alleles from the mixed population.

Sewage - Domestic waste water containing various solid and liquid waste materials including human excreta.

Single cell protein (SCP) – A protein derived from a culture of single celled organisms used especially as a food supplement.

SOD– Sediment Oxygen Demand is the rate at which dissolved oxygen is removed from the water column during the decomposition of organic matter in streambed or lakebed sediments.

Solubilisation – Dissolving the feed stock in water to make a slurry for anaerobic digestion.

Speciation – Formation of new species from the pre-existing ones.

Structural gene – A gene coding for the structure of a protein.

Taq DNA polymerase– A thermostable DNA polymerase obtained from thermophilic bacterium Thermus aquaticus. It helps in the synthesis of DNA.

Transgene– The target gene responsible for the development of transgenic organism.

Trophozoite stage – In Plasmodium life cycle, cryptomerozoites in the RBC become round and it modifies into a young trophozoite.

Umbilical cord – Structure bearing arteries and veins connecting the placenta and the foetus.

Variations – Dissimilarity between the members of the same species.

Vitrification– Transformation of a substance into a glass.

Volatility– A liquid or substance is one that will quickly change into a gas.

Withdrawal symptoms - The reactions experienced by an addict after he/she stops using drugs.

Woolly mammoth – A hairy relative of modern elephant that lived in cold climates.

Zoogeography – Study of details with the geographical distribution of animals.

Zygote intra fallopian transfer-(ZIFT) Transfer of zygote or embryo with 8 or less than 8 celled blastomeres into the fallopian tube.

TN_GOVT_XII_Glossary.indd 239 24-02-2020 4.05.30 PM